Historical source

Encyclopaedia Britannica scan, source row 2307. Parse 3.5 extracted the text. Super 3.5 VL corrected it from an enlarged crop of each block. It can still contain recognition errors. Page headers, footers, and page numbers are removed.

Untitled continuation (E0214)

Continues an entry from an earlier page.

Algiers.

for their valour against the enemies of Christianity. Even ladies of birth and character attended Charles in his expedition, and the wives and daughters of the officers and soldiers followed them with a design to settle in Barbary after the conquest was finished. All these meeting with a favourable wind, soon appeared before Algiers; every ship displaying the Spanish colours on the stern, and another at the head, with a crucifix to serve them for a pilot.

By this prodigious armament, the Algerines were thrown into the utmost consternation. The city was surrounded only by a wall with force any outworks. The whole garrison consisted of 800 Turks and 6000 Moors, without fire-arms, and poorly disciplined and accoutred; the rest of their forces being dispersed in the other provinces of the kingdom, to levy the usual tribute on the Arabs and Moors. The Spaniards landed without opposition, and immediately built a fort, under the cannon of which they encamped, and diverted the course of a spring which supplied the city with water. Being now reduced to the utmost distress, Hassan received a summons to surrender at discretion, on pain of being put to the sword with all the garrison. The herald was ordered to exert the whole power of the emperor both by sea and land, and to exhort him to return to the Christian religion. But to this Hassan only replied, that he must be a madman who would pretend to advise an enemy, and that the advised must act more madly who would take counsel of such an adviser. He was, however, on the point of surrendering the city, when advice was brought him that the forces belonging to the western government were in full march towards the place; upon which it was resolved to defend it to the utmost. Charles, in the meantime, revolving upon a general assault, kept a constant firing upon the town; which, from the weak defence made by the garrison, he looked upon as already in his hands. But while the divan, or Algerine senate, were deliberating on the most proper means of obtaining an honourable capitulation, a mad prophet, attended by a multitude of people, entered the assembly, and foretold the speedy destruction of the Spaniards before the end of the moon, exhorting the inhabitants to hold out till that time. This prediction was soon accomplished in a very surprising and unexpected manner: for, on the 28th of October 1541, a dreadful storm of wind, rain, and hail, arose from the north, accompanied with violent flocks of earthquakes, and a dismal and universal darkness both by sea and land; so that the sun, moon, and elements, seemed to combine together for the destruction of the Spaniards. In that one night, less than half an hour, 86 ships and 15 galleys were destroyed, with all their crews and military stores; by which the army on shore was deprived of all means of subsistence in those parts. Their camp also, which spread itself along the plain under the fort, was laid quite under water by the torrents which descended from the neighbouring hills. Many of the troops, by trying to remove into some better situation, were cut in pieces by the Moors and Arabs; while several galleys, and other vessels, endeavouring to gain some neighbouring creeks along the coasts, were immediately plundered, and their crews massacred by the inhabitants.

The next morning, Charles beheld the sea covered with the fragments of so many ships, and the bodies of

men, horses, and other creatures, swimming on the waves; at which he was so disheartened, that abandoning his tents, artillery, and all his heavy baggage, to the enemy, he marched at the head of his army, though in no small disorder, towards cape Malabux, in order to re-embark in those few vessels which had outweathered the storm. But Hassan, who had caused his motions to be watched, allowed him just time to get to the shore, when he sallied out and attacked the Spaniards in the midst of their hurry and confusion to get into their ships, killing great numbers, and bringing away a full greater number of captives; after which he returned in triumph to Algiers, where he celebrated with great rejoicings his happy delivery from such difficulties and danger.

Soon after this, the prophet Yufef, who had foretold the destruction of the Spaniards, was not only declared the deliverer of his country, but had a considerable gratuity decreed him, with the liberty of exercising his prophetic function unmolested. It was not long, however, before the marabouts, and some interpreters of the law, made a strong opposition against him; remonstrating to the bashaw, how ridiculous and scandalous it was to their nation, to ascribe the deliverance of it to a poor fortune-teller, which had been obtained by the fervent prayers of an eminent saint of their own profession. But tho' the bashaw and his douwan seemed, out of policy, to give into this last notion, yet the impression which Yufef's predictions and their late accomplishment had made upon the minds of the common people, proved too strong to be eradicated; and the spirit of divination and conjuring has since got

into such credit among them, that not only their great statesmen, but their priests, marabouts, and fantoons, have applied themselves to that study, and dignified it with the name of Mahometan's Revelations.

The unhappy Spaniards had scarce reached their ships, when they were attacked by a fresh storm, in which several more of them perished; one ship in par-

Haffan, elated with this victory, in which he had very little share, undertook an expedition against the king of Tremecen, who, being now deprived of the assistance of the Spaniards, was forced to procure a peace

fiftance of the Spaniards, was forced to procure a peace by paying a vast sum of money, and becoming tributary Algiers.

:8 ge of Al- ders railed.

Spaniish fleet destroyed by a storm.

16 Prevented by a mad prophet from for- rendering.

27 Spanish feet destroyed by a storm.

her creatures, swimming on the was fo difheartened, that abandon- y, and all his heavy baggage, to d at the head of his army, though towards cape Malabux, in order Algiers. :9 Siege of Al- giers railed.

Source record

Scan ID `britannica:309f765b1ecc83e0a7f7762e44b4a927a7555443:train:2307`

Image file `page-2307-4ce2ea50e9d2.jpg`

Image SHA-256 `4ce2ea50e9d2f4035fe1405b86ee2d40131a8b739a494cc64b0c0fab124fe2a5`

Dataset NationalLibraryOfScotland/encyclopaedia_britannica_illustrated at revision `309f765b1ecc83e0a7f7762e44b4a927a7555443` (CC0-1.0)

Extraction model `nvidia/nemotron-3.5-parse`, raw reply `extract/raw/page-2307-4ce2ea50e9d2.json`

Raw reply SHA-256 `8a631e5e3d271ff3c8aae484b192f6e20f30343046e26a0b543567d1cc02a264`

Correction model `nvidia/Nemotron-3.5-Super-VL`, block crops, raw replies `correct/raw/crop_nothink/page-2307-4ce2ea50e9d2-b*.json`; super_vl: 15

Running header **AL G** **241** **A L G**